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Syllabus 2025



01

Academic Content



- **Course Title:** Next Level Skills for Student Leaders (NELS)
- **Credits / ECTS:** 3ECTS after completing the whole course
- **Target Audience:** higher education students, student leaders, prospective student leaders
- **Course Description**

NELS is a dynamic virtual exchange course designed to equip current and aspiring student leaders in Europe and Sub-Saharan Africa with the next-level skills needed to lead change on their campuses and in their communities. Through interactive sessions, collaborative projects, and intercultural dialogue, students will gain practical skills, build strong networks, and engage deeply with real-world leadership challenges

The NELS course offers **one welcome session** and **five thematic sessions** per semester, all delivered online to ensure accessibility and inclusion. Sessions run twice per semester to allow flexible participation and are led by experienced facilitators and student organisation representatives from across Africa and Europe.

The core thematic areas are:



Welcome
Session



Future
Challenges



Next-Level
Skills



New Ways of
Student Organising



Course Session



Welcome Session



Future Challenges

o Future Skills and Megatrends

Examines global shifts like digitalisation, climate change, and demographic change, and how these impact higher education and leadership.

o Digitalisation and Digital Transformation

Focuses on the implications of digital technology in education, activism, and governance, offering tools for digital leadership and innovation.



Next-Level Skills

o Leadership for Student Leaders

Builds essential leadership capabilities including ethical decision-making, time management, and goal setting within student governance contexts.

o Communication in the Virtual Space

Strengthens students' ability to communicate effectively and inclusively in online environments, with a focus on collaboration and clarity.



New Ways of Student Organising

o New Ways of Student Organising I

Discusses emerging models of student mobilisation, focusing on digital activism, decentralised leadership, and participatory governance.



Teaching Methods

Each session combines:

- Expert input
- Group-based assignments
- Real-world case discussions
- Action-based learning and reflection

Learning Outcomes

- Enhance leadership and communication skills
- Master conflict resolution and digital collaboration tools
- Strengthen critical thinking, creativity, and problem-solving
- Deepen intercultural awareness and global citizenship
- Advocate more effectively for sustainability and inclusion in higher education

• Assessment

- Session Badges by completing short task
- Workload for 3ECTS
 - o Active participation
 - o Small leadership project presentation
 - o Reflection paper of the project experience (1000 words) and peer feedback of paper written by other peers



Schedule / Duration

each session will last 150'

Session	1st Offer	2nd Offer
Pre-Session	17th October 2025 10:00 GMT	3rd November 2025 12:00 GMT
Future Minds and Megatrends	20th October 2025 10:00 GMT	5th November 2025 12:00 GMT
Digitalisation and Digital Transformation	22nd October 2025 10:00 GMT	7th November 2025 12:00 GMT
Leadership for Student Leaders	24th October 2025 10:00 GMT	12th November 2025 12:00 GMT
Communication for Student Leaders - Virtual Space	28th October 2025 10:00 GMT	13th November 2025 12:00 GMT
New Ways of Students Organizing 1	30th October 2025 10:00 GMT	14th November 2025 12:00 GMT

First offer

10:00GMT (Europe: 12:00) (Ghana and Gambia: 10:00; Kenya: 13:00)

Second offer

12:00 GMT (Europe: 14:00) (Ghana and Gambia: 12:00; Kenya: 15:00)



Modes of Participation & Recognition



Students can choose to:

- **Attend selected individual sessions.**
After each session, participants will receive a certificate of participation.
- **Participate in the full course (1 Welcome session + 5 sessions)**
Those who complete the full programme and submit a personal skills portfolio are eligible to receive micro-credentials (Europe an-standard ECTS credits) issued by FH OOE.
Participants not submitting portfolios will still receive a certificate of participation.

Registration: through the website

nels.training

Need help?

EMAIL: skills4studentleaders@gmail.com

FACEBOOK: Next Level Skills for Student Leaders – NELS

LINKEDIN: Next Level Skills for Student Leaders – NELS

INSTAGRAM: Next Level Skills for Student Leaders



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